



BharatQR Code: Not Just For Payments

- BharatQR code is a transformative step towards easing and encouraging cashless payments
- BharatQR is multi-purpose and can be applied in various facets of a business

Enterprises in India are finally waking up to the QR code technology. Taking a leaf from other countries, the Indian government has launched a common QR code, BharatQR, with the aim to "reform" the payment systems in the country.

"BharatQR code is a transformative step towards easing and encouraging cashless payments. It makes digital payments far cheaper, and its key benefits like interoperability and seamless transactions make it extremely attractive for both merchants and customers," shares Kishore Biyani, CEO of Future Group.

"At Future Group, we are experimenting with the technology with the objective to roll it out in our stores in the near future. However, we believe there will be even more innovation in the payments area in

the near future that will make digital transactions even more intuitive, easy and accessible for every segment of Indian citizens. BharatQR code is a big step towards this direction," Biyani adds.

While the government might have wanted to only change the payment mechanisms in the country, this revolutionary technology is actually multi-purpose and can be applied in various facets of a business.

Increase sales

No retailer can ignore the fact that most customers today first go online to do their research (for reviews, best price and quality of products) before buying a product. And not all are willing to come to the physical store to shop what they want. With the infrastructure for a common QR Code already

laid down, companies can generate their code on BharatQR and display it on their online store. When customers visit their online sites to see what is available in their stores, they can order and use the QR code to scan the payment. This allows companies to sell the stocks available in their brick-and-mortar stores, thus substantially increasing their sales.

Back in 2011, Verizon achieved a 200 per cent increase in its sales using QR codes. The company simply displayed QR codes in stores that enabled customers to enter a competition. Customers were required to share the brand's advertisements on social media, and if their friend bought a product, they would get a smartphone. According to reports, the company clocked in an additional \$35,000